



01 What It Is

Shields is a diffuse algorithmic reverb built around the Alesis Midiverb II's "Bloom" algorithm (its presets 45 and 49), a shoegaze-favorite effect where energy density builds slowly before decaying.

Every parameter was tuned by comparing the plugin's own output against impulse response captures of the original hardware. One control, Wobble, doesn't exist on the original hardware at all: it's a new way to blur the tank's resonant peaks into motion without changing the default static character.

02 Signal Path

Signal moves through Shields in a fixed order. Low EQ Cutoff and Diffusion shape what reaches the reverb tank; Tone and the Wet/Dry pair shape what leaves it.



03 The Panel

- DIFFUSION
- DECAY
- MOTION
- TONE
- MIX

DIFFUSION

DIFFUSION

0.50

Size

1.00x

Diffusion

0.30-0.70 · default 0.50

Smears the incoming signal before it reaches the reverb. Turn either direction to change how quickly discrete echoes blur into a smooth wash.

DECAY

FEEDBACK

99.0%

TREBLE DECAY

20.0%

Feedback

0-100% · default 99%

Sets the tank's decay time by controlling how much signal recirculates on every pass. Larger values mean a longer reverb.

Treble Decay

0-100% · default 20%

A filter in the tank's feedback path that rolls off high frequencies faster than lows on every pass, darkening the tail as it decays. Higher values lose treble faster, for a duller, more muffled tail.

MOTION

WOBBLE

0.0%

Wobble

0-100% · default 0%

An optional slow drift added to the tank's delay lines, blurring its resonant peaks into gentle motion. At 0% the engine behaves exactly as if Wobble didn't exist; turn it up to soften an otherwise static, slightly metallic character.

TONE

LOW EQ CUTOFF

20 Hz

HIGH EQ CUTOFF

19000 Hz

BIT DEPTH

13.0 bit

Low EQ Cutoff

20-200 Hz · default 20 Hz

A gentle input high-pass ahead of the diffuser and tank. At its 20 Hz floor it's effectively bypassed; raise it to keep low end out of the reverb entirely.

High EQ Cutoff

1-20 kHz · default 19 kHz

The main brightness control, it's a low-pass filter on the output. Lower it for a darker, more vintage-sounding tail.

Bit Depth

4-16 bit · default 13 bit

The Midiverb is a 13-bit piece of hardware. Here we let you go a bit higher and a lot lower, to make it cleaner or more lo-fi.

MIX

DRY

100.0%

WET

40.0%

Dry

0-100% · default 100%

Level of the untouched input.

Wet

0-200% · default 40%

Level of the processed signal, independent of Dry. It can be pushed past unity for an exaggerated, obviously-effected sound.

A Bypass switch sits at the top right of the panel — it mutes the effect entirely, passing dry signal only, for quick A/B comparison.